QuoteCat

State Contractor Licensing

Quick Reference

A companion to The 90-Day Contractor Startup Kit

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How to Use This Table

- **License Required:** Does the state require a statewide contractor license?
- **Threshold:** Minimum project value that triggers licensing requirement
- **Bond Required:** Does the state require a surety bond?
- **Notes:** Important details for that state

Always verify with your state's licensing board - requirements change, and local jurisdictions may have additional rules.

50-State Licensing Requirements

State	License?	Threshold	Bond?	Notes
Alabama	Yes	>$50,000	Yes	Lower threshold some trades
Alaska	Yes	All work	Yes	Endorsement for specialties
Arizona	Yes	All work	Yes	ROC license required
Arkansas	Yes	>$50,000	Yes	Residential only at state
California	Yes	>$500	Yes $25K	Strictest in nation
Colorado	No	Check local	Varies	Denver, Boulder require
Connecticut	Yes	All work	No	HIC registration required
Delaware	No	Check local	Varies	Local licenses may apply
Florida	Yes	All work	Yes	State or local required
Georgia	Yes	>$2,500	Yes $25K	Residential & commercial
Hawaii	Yes	All work	Yes	Must pass exam
Idaho	No	Check local	Varies	Public works require reg
Illinois	No	Check local	Varies	Chicago requires license
Indiana	No	Check local	Varies	Trade licenses at state
Iowa	No	Check local	Varies	Registration some trades
Kansas	No	Check local	Varies	Local jurisdictions vary
Kentucky	No	Check local	Varies	Trade licenses required
Louisiana	Yes	>$50,000	Yes	Residential & commercial
Maine	No	Check local	Varies	Some trades require
Maryland	Yes	All work	No	MHIC license required
Massachusetts	Yes	All work	No	CSL and HIC registration
Michigan	Yes	>$600	No	Residential builders
Minnesota	Yes	All work	No	Residential only
Mississippi	Yes	>$50,000	Yes	Residential contractors
Missouri	No	Check local	Varies	KC, St. Louis require
Montana	No	Check local	Varies	Registration required
Nebraska	No	Check local	Varies	Registration required
Nevada	Yes	All work	Yes	Strict requirements
New Hampshire	No	Check local	Varies	Trade licenses only
New Jersey	Yes	All work	No	HIC registration required
New Mexico	Yes	All work	Yes	GB-2 or GB-98 license
New York	No	NYC requires	Varies	NYC strict requirements
North Carolina	Yes	>$30,000	No	General contractors
North Dakota	Yes	All work	Yes	Class A, B, C, D
Ohio	No	Check local	Varies	Many cities require
Oklahoma	No	Check local	Varies	Trade licenses at state
Oregon	Yes	All work	Yes $20K	CCB license required
Pennsylvania	No	Check local	Varies	Philly, Pittsburgh require

Rhode Island	Yes	All work	No	Registration required
South Carolina	Yes	All work	No	Residential builders
South Dakota	No	Check local	Varies	Excise tax license only
Tennessee	Yes	>$25,000	Yes	Home improvement
Texas	No	Trade only	Varies	HVAC, elec, plumb licensed
Utah	Yes	All work	No	DOPL license required
Vermont	No	Check local	Varies	Registration required
Virginia	Yes	>$1,000	No	Class A, B, C licenses
Washington	Yes	All work	Yes	L&I registration required
West Virginia	Yes	All work	Yes	WV license required
Wisconsin	No	Check local	Varies	Dwelling contractor cred
Wyoming	No	Check local	Varies	Sales tax license only

Trade-Specific Licenses

These trades typically require a separate license regardless of general contractor requirements:

Trade	Typical Requirement
Electrician	Journeyman or Master license
Plumber	Journeyman or Master license
HVAC	EPA 608 certification + state license
Roofing	Often separate license required
Fire Protection	State license usually required

Next Steps

1. Search “[your state] contractor license requirements”
2. Visit your state’s contractor licensing board website
3. Call your local building department
4. Check if your city/county has additional requirements

Sources: Procore Contractor License Guide; Harbor Compliance; NASCLA; Individual state licensing boards (2025-2026)

This reference is part of The 90-Day Contractor Startup Kit from QuoteCat.

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